



Sunday, the 21st of April 2024



MUNOB 2024

Discussions on Radical Ideologies and Cultural Preservation in the Disarmament and International Security Council

The Disarmament and International Security Council brought into discussion topics such as the rapid development of radical ideologies and the effects of these issues on regional cultures. A number of questions arose after the delegate of Israel stated their motion, reflecting upon the ethnic conflicts in the Middle East, especially the Kurdish-Arab tensions. The official sought support from member states to modify a UN amendment so that cultural and linguistic oppression can be fought against. The Israeli motion was highly criticized by the Syrian delegate, as they found that the amendment wouldn't bring any real change to the situation. Following these remarks, officials called upon the Syrian representative to explain the rationale behind intending to wipe out Kurdish culture in Iraq. The United States stated their intention to support Kurdish traditions so as to help preserve the culture and promote it around the world in countries with important Kurdish communities, such as Germany.



After the voting session, the Chairs announced the passing of the amendment.

Delegates also talked about demilitarized zones in Iraq, although these didn't seem to make any difference in the issue. Middle Eastern delegates brought into discussion the numerous bombings against US and Iraqi troops in the region. The possibility of sending UN troops did arise, even though the proposal did not pass. In light of these issues, the US pledged that NATO is willing to help Iraq against terrorist attacks, whilst respecting the Finnish amendment presented to the commission, which called for cooperation.

Economic and Financial Committee Ponders Economic Stability: Crafting Solutions for Emerging Markets' Challenges

The 2024 MUNOB Economic and Financial Committee continued the discussions, reflecting on how to tackle the effects of illegal activities that occur within emerging markets. Representatives commented on the importance of justice for criminals that were involved in pyramid schemes.

MUNOB 2024



The Argentinian delegate asked the UN to collaborate in order to create a well-written resolution so that together they may achieve a more stable economy, facing the recurring problems posed by the pandemic. Numerous countries noted their struggles with inflation and unemployment. In combating this challenge, Argentina told the members that they are considering cutting internal infrastructure spendings, alongside with reducing circa 50% of political jobs. The representative underlined that their goal isn't that of asking for monetary support from other countries, but of trying to find international collaborations to fix their economy for the long run.

The debates took in consideration the problems arising in the quality of life of countries affected by unemployment. Such issues may have a strong impact on parents being unable to meet basic needs for their children.



Information is Power in the Social Humanitarian & Cultural Committee

On Sunday, the Committee on Social Humanitarian and Cultural Issues engaged in heated discussion on the spread of misinformation in regions affected by military conflicts. 'Information is power' - that was the message of the representatives. Delegates called for promoting local journalism, as propaganda has always circulated mostly in the media, and especially social media today.

During the presentations, the delegate for the Russian Federation reflected on the usage of AI as a weapon in numerous cyber wars.

Some of the MUN delegates kept in mind Russia's past in spreading false information and thus the Federation's representative was asked to answer a number of questions regarding the ways that they plan to differentiate truth from lies, in light of the difficulties posed by widespread conflicting information on the internet. Iran followed up on this issue, considering that censorship may be a viable solution, as the government plays an important role in controlling misinformation.

However, the Iranian remarks were met with unanimous criticism on behalf of the delegates, as numerous violent acts are known to have taken place in the region, mostly against women trying to execute their right to freedom of speech.

MUNOB 2024

Addressing the Tibetan Conflicts in the Special Political & Decolonization Committee

On the third day of MUNOB, the Special Political & Decolonization Committee discussed the conflicts in the Tibetan region. The US representative strongly stated the country's position in the situation, considering that Chinese oppression against the people of Tibet needs to find an immediate solution. Evidently, since the annexation in October 1951, numerous rights have been violated, such as the right to life, freedom and religious liberty, which led to an appeal to consider economic sanctions on the Chinese Republic.

In light of these resolutions, questions arose about the nature of the economic relations between China and the rest of the world, as such penalties may affect the world economy, which is deeply dependent on the Chinese system.



Security Council Tackles the South Sudan Crisis

Sunday's Security Council began with discussions regarding the humanitarian crisis happening in South Sudan. Delegates have been looking to find ways to solve the ethnic violence between the local tribes. Numerous representatives called upon finding ways to minimise outbreaks in the Abyei region. Thus, the United States called for demilitarisation, considering the need for humanitarian aid and the safety of transporting resources. Other representatives called for cease fire and peaceful dialogue, considering that diplomatic pathways would be the most appropriate to find solutions to the issue.

However, inquiries appeared when the US stated that, in case of escalation, violence would be inevitable. Overall, the council's discussions gravitated mostly around finding ways to keep the ethnic tribes in Abyei safe.

MUNOB 2024



UNODC Debates Resolution Impact on Human Rights

Today, the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime deliberated on a resolution put forward by the Eastern bloc, as the United States voiced concerns about the resolution's potential effects on human rights and civil liberties, particularly regarding its provision to allocate 0.01% of each country's GDP to the campaigns. Additionally, the US raised concerns about the involvement of military personnel, fearing it could trigger feelings of containment among the population. In response, Russia argued that military assistance would bolster border security efforts.

The debate intensified as the Nigerian delegate proposed a program aimed at assisting former drug addicts by providing shelter and employment opportunities. Jobs would be offered post-rehabilitation, contingent upon their readiness to reintegrate into society. Iran voiced support for Nigeria's initiative, while South Africa and Syria expressed skepticism, implying economic constraints that may hinder certain countries from implementing such comprehensive rehabilitation programs.

“We fight for Them”: Controversial Deliberations in the Commission on the Status of Women

On Sunday, the Commission on the Status of Women tackled several speeches regarding their clauses and amendments, including one from the Republic of Congo. Following this, the delegate faced questioning regarding the effectiveness of border control in combating sex trafficking. Additionally, concerns were raised about sexual abuse by soldiers in the Republic of Congo, to which the delegate pledged sanctions.

Subsequently, Turkey delivered a speech opposing the inclusion of religious institutions in one clause of the resolution. They argued against its relevance and potential to ignite sensitivities among certain countries, particularly in the context of the sex industry. This stance sparked controversy and confusion among delegates, given Turkey's religious identity.



MUNOB 2024

Following this, the Russian Federation recommended that member states clarify the definition of prostitution and outline prohibited actions against sex workers. They proposed revising the official definition to incorporate additional factors relevant to prostitution. Furthermore, Russia suggested promoting informational campaigns to raise awareness and reduce stigma surrounding the sex industry, emphasizing the importance of offering encouragement towards creating those campaigns.



Crisis Committee: Insights from the Chair

As tensions escalate on multiple fronts, the Crisis Committee finds itself at the center of developments. The long-standing friction between the United States and Aiblig has reached a critical point, with Pakistan's unexpected intervention following its control of the Swiss Canal. Adding to the complexity, a devastating fire in Southern Siberia has covered Europe in a thick fog, affecting countries far beyond the immediate vicinity. Moreover, concerns have been raised about the potential spread of a new Covid strain carried by migrants from Russia, further complicating international efforts to contain the pandemic.



China's decisive action to close its borders with Russia has sent shockwaves through diplomatic circles, while the Democratic People's Republic of Korea's unexpected friendliness towards Russian migrants raises questions about shifting alliances. In a surprising turn of events, Serbia has been named The Republic of Great Yugoslavia, as Syria has transformed into Kyrgyzstan.

Amidst these changes, Ukraine finds itself in a delicate situation because of Russian migrants establishing a cult, effectively seizing control of the country, but also carrying what seems to be a new Covid strain. Furthermore, the recent death of Putin has led to a surprising alliance between Russia and the US, shifting the alliances from the past.

Debates & Proposals in the CTC Committee

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MUNOB 2024

In the Counter-Terrorism Committee, discussions took up the supervision of programs aimed at combating extremism. A proposed amendment aimed to address radicalization on the internet by regulating extremist content. Afghanistan emerged as a potential supervisor for these efforts, with the belief that its neutrality makes it an ideal candidate. The proposal suggested that a modest percentage of GDP contributions could enable even economically challenged countries to participate effectively, an idea that was proposed by the Democratic People's Republic of Korea.

Afghanistan expressed gratitude for the DPRK's recognition of its neutrality and clarified that participation in the program is voluntary for countries, emphasizing sovereignty in decision-making.

Following this, Turkey proposed striking religious groups from the discussion, a notion supported by Israel, which questioned the role of religion in terrorism. The exchange reflected the complexity of addressing ideological underpinnings in counter-terrorism efforts.



Extremists' Reintegration Discussed in the Human Rights Council

In a heated session in the Human Rights Council, Syria's delegation fiercely opposed the proposal regarding some programmes aimed to provide rehabilitation of extremists. They argue that reintegrating those individuals into society is unnecessary, sparking concerns about how to best approach this issue. Syria expresses skepticism towards proposals meant to raise awareness on the challenges faced by those in the Sahel region, which they attribute to Western propaganda. Delegates questioned Syria's ability to talk about human rights, particularly in light of their reluctance to reintegrate extremists into society. Sweden emerged as a vocal opponent of Syria's stance, emphasizing the importance of rehabilitation programs and their openness to the support provided by any delegation.